

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)**Section A: General Contract Information**

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Contracting Activity: FA5613

Project/Program Name: AO tech Refresh

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: F3NT176057AW01

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): \$0.00

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

The request is for the purchase of eight enterprise network switches and associated licensing, accessories, and support components required to support and modernize the organization's network infrastructure. These switches will provide secure and reliable connectivity for systems, users, and mission operations. The package includes the switch hardware, required software licensing, storage modules, transceiver modules, spare expansion modules, and shipping for overseas delivery. These items will be used to maintain and improve network performance, reliability, and operational capability within the existing infrastructure.

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

The requested equipment must be Cisco Catalyst 9300 series switches to maintain compatibility with the existing network infrastructure currently deployed within the organization. The existing network architecture, configuration standards, and cybersecurity compliance requirements are built around Cisco networking equipment. Introducing a different manufacturer would require significant reconfiguration of the current network environment, additional testing, and potential redesign of existing routing, switching, and security policies. The Cisco Catalyst 9300 platform provides specific capabilities required for the current environment, including compatibility with the organization's existing Cisco-based network management systems, software licensing structure, and operational configurations. The requested switches support the same operating system, management tools, and configuration standards already in use, which ensures seamless integration with the current infrastructure and minimizes operational risk. Additionally, the network environment must remain compliant with Department of Defense cybersecurity requirements, including established security configuration guidance and hardening procedures already developed for Cisco platforms. Deploying equipment from another manufacturer would require the development, validation, and approval of new security configurations and operational procedures, which would significantly delay deployment and increase cost and risk to mission operations.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

Market research was conducted using the CHES (chess.army.mil) procurement program to identify authorized vendors capable of supplying the required Cisco equipment. Multiple CHES-approved vendors were reviewed and quotes were obtained for the requested Cisco Catalyst 9300 switches and associated components. While multiple vendors can provide the equipment, the requirement remains for Cisco brand-name hardware to ensure compatibility with the existing network infrastructure.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

Future acquisitions will include continued market research and review of available network equipment solutions to determine if alternative vendors can meet operational and compatibility requirements. The requiring activity will also evaluate emerging technologies and conduct market surveys prior to future procurements to identify potential competitive sources where feasible.

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Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer	Signature of Contracting Officer
01-Apr-2026	SrA Tristan Gallemore	